National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Statesboro, GA	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA037
Date & Time:	11/17/2007, 1630 EST	**Registration:**	N6492E
Aircraft:	Cessna 172N	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

The 27-hour student pilot of the Cessna 172N successfully completed the first leg of a solo cross country flight, and returned for landing on runway 23 at his airport of origin. The pilot reported that on final approach, he was lined up correctly, was at the appropriate speed, and that everything "felt good." He also reported that when he began the flare, a gust of wind "caught the back of the plane," and lifted the tail. The pilot believed that he had landed nose gear first. He completed the rollout and taxied to the terminal without further incident. The pilot did not experience any preimpact failures or malfunctions with the airplane, and a postaccident examination of the airplane revealed damage to the propeller, nose landing gear and firewall. The weather observation at the airport about the time of the accident recorded winds from 220 degrees at 4 knots.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The student pilot's failure to maintain a proper flare at touchdown.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - IN FLIGHT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
1. (C) FLARE - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: HARD LANDING
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	33, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	09/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	27 hours (Total, all aircraft), 12 hours (Total, this make and model), 5 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 27 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 11 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 1 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N6492E
Model/Series:	172N	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	17272024
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	11/01/2007, 100 Hour	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2400 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	8616 Hours at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-320
Registered Owner:	Pegasus Air	**Rated Power:**	160 hp
Operator:	Pegasus Air	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None
Operator Does Business As:	Pegasus Air	**Operator Designator Code:**	

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	TBR, 187 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	0 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1620 EST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	4 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	220°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.1 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	18°C / -1°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Barnwell, SC (BNL)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Statesboro, GA (TBR)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	1545 EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Statesboro-Bulloch County (TBR)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	187 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	23	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	4383 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	32.482778, -81.736944

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Michael Huhn	**Report Date:**	04/30/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Jim Payne; FAA/FSDO; Atlanta, GA		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.